

Emploid Design System & Brand Guidelines

1. Visual Identity & Ethos

Emploid's aesthetic is positioned at the intersection of an **editorial trust-publication** (like a high-end investigative newspaper) and a **modern indie product**. It avoids the generic, hyper-saturated gradients, pastel rainbows, and rounded glassmorphism common in Silicon Valley SaaS apps. The presentation relies on sharp typography, a controlled color palette, and structured lines.

2. Color System

The color palette is anchored by a sharp contrast between warm orange (representing embers and activity) and deep navy (representing trust and structure) on a clean, off-white canvas.

Core Palette

- **Signature Accent & Primary CTA:** ``#c85b24`` (orange-500). Used for primary buttons, active pagination, section kickers, highlighted borders, and SVG progress rings.
- **Deep Navy Surfaces:** ``#0c1728`` to ``#122035`` linear gradients. Used for the dark hero section, page footers, dark summary cards, and modal background overlays.
- **App Chrome & Layout Backgrounds:** ``#f5f7fb`` (cool off-white paper). A slightly darker shade, ``#edf3fa`` (cool grey-blue), is used for nested sidebars, panels, and inner container backgrounds.
- **Neutral Texts:** ``#122035`` (navy-900) for headings, ``#3b4e66`` (slate-700) for body copy, and ``#647b99`` (slate-500) for secondary details or captions.

Semantic Trust Colors

The proprietary Trust Score is color-coded using specific combinations of background, text, and border lines:

- **High Trust (80-100):** Dark green text ``#1f7a42`` on soft green background ``#ecf8f0``, with border ``#b8dfc5``.
 - **Medium Trust (50-79):** Deep orange text ``#b8611b`` on soft orange background ``#fff3e7``, with border ``#f4cf7f``.
 - **Low Trust (0-49):** Deep red text ``#b33a3a`` on soft red background ``#fff0f0``, with border ``#f6c4c4``.
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3. Typography

Typography is a defining feature of the brand's editorial weight. Headings must have high contrast and tight spacing.

- **Display & Headings: Filson Pro** (weights 700 Bold and 900 Heavy). Used for all main page titles, headers, statistic numbers, and logos.
 - ***Tracking:** Set to ``-0.04em`` on H1 and ``-0.03em`` on H2 to give a compact, authoritative newspaper feel.
 - ***Google Fonts Fallback:** **Manrope** (bold/extra-bold). Recommended for public/licensing-safe deployments.
 - **Body & Controls: Satoshi** (weights 400 Regular, 500 Medium, 700 Bold). Used for body paragraphs, labels, metadata, and buttons.
 - ***Line Height:** Maintained at ``1.6`` for readable body text and ``1.04`` for headings.
 - ***Google Fonts Fallback:** **Inter** (regular/medium/bold).
 - **Monospace Text:** System mono stack (``ui-monospace``, `SFMono-Regular`, `Menlo``). Used strictly for stats counters, source pill labels, and browser-address previews.
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4. Layout & Grid Rules

- **Maximum Width:** Content container is capped at ``1200px`` wide, centered, with ``24px`` horizontal gutters on mobile/tablet.
 - **Vertical Spacing:** Core homepage sections use ``padding: 64px 0`` for breathing room. Product dashboards and filters are tighter (``24px`` to ``40px`` padding).
 - **Sticky Navigation:** Nav bar is ``68px`` tall, sticky at the top, and uses a frosted white overlay (``rgba(255,255,255,0.96)``) with ``backdrop-filter: blur(16px)`` and a subtle shadow that activates on page scroll.
 - **Grid Layouts:**
 - ***Hero Section:** 2-column layout (``1fr`` copy left, ``480px`` browser window preview right).
 - ***Browse Jobs Dashboard:** 2-column layout (``250px`` sticky filter panel left, ``1fr`` scrollable job list cards right).
 - ***Tracker Header:** 2-column layout (``1fr`` section header left, ``400px`` 2x2 grid of stat summaries right).
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5. UI Elements & Components

Buttons & Tap Targets

- **Interactive Targets:** Must maintain a minimum tap height of ``44px`` for accessibility.
- **Shape:** All buttons, filters, tag pills, and input controls use a **fully rounded pill** shape (``border-radius: 999px``).
- **Primary Buttons:** Solid ``#c85b24`` background, white text. Hover state translates up by ``1px``.

(`transform: translateY(-1px)`) and shifts color to deep orange (`#aa4717`). It uses an orange-tinted shadow (`box-shadow: 0 14px 26px rgba(200,91,36,0.2)`).

Containers & Cards

- **Card Containers:** White background, thin grey-blue border (`1px solid rgba(188, 201, 216, 0.7)`), and soft navy shadow. Corner radius is set between `8px` and `12px`.
- **Modals:** Use a `16px` to `24px` corner radius. The overlay uses a dark navy tint (`rgba(8,17,31,0.72)`) with a `8px` backdrop blur.

Trust Score Ring

The SVG progress ring is the core visual identifier:

- **Track Ring:** Outer grey circle `#d7e0ea` with `stroke-width: 3`.
- **Fill Ring:** Colored according to the semantic trust level (green/orange/red) with `stroke-width: 3` and `stroke-dasharray` matching the score percentage.
- **Value:** Score number is centered inside the ring in bold Filson Pro.
- **Sizes:** Standard inline size is `30px`; high-detail modal size is `72px`.

6. Motion & Transitions

Movement in the Employd interface is functional and controlled.

- **Global Timing:** Use `transition: 180ms ease` for all hover states.
- **Stage Slider Sweep:** When an application transitions stage in the Tracker (e.g. from Saved to Applied), a warm orange gradient sheen sweeps from left to right across the progress bar over `620ms` (no bouncy physics or confetti).
- **Modal Entry:** Fade in and slide up (`translateY(16px)` to `0`) over `220ms` using `cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)`.

7. Design Don'ts (Strict Constraints)

- **NO Gradient/Rainbow Text:** Text should be solid navy or white.
- **NO Blue-to-Purple Gradients:** Navy-to-slate or dark-navy gradients are allowed, but tech-startup style blue/violet blends are banned.
- **NO Emojis in UI:** Emojis degrade the editorial authority of the brand.
- **NO Colored Left Borders on Cards:** Avoid the common SaaS pattern of a solid 4px colored strip on the left edge of a card. Use full semantic border/background fills instead.
- **NO Photography Backgrounds:** Avoid using photos or abstract 3D illustrations. Rely on typography, grid lines, and flat solid shapes.
- **NO Mascot Overuse:** The pixel-art ghost mascot (`ghost-pixel.svg`) is reserved exclusively for empty states or error pages (404). It must never appear in the main navigation, headers, or buttons.